Sisterhood Tea Healing Circle Facilitation Manual

Culturally Specific Trauma Recovery Framework - Founded by Comfort Dondo

Phumulani: Minnesota African Women Against Violence - 501c3 Certified Community Resource

1. Philosophy of Sacred Rest and Phumulani

In Zulu, Phumulani means to rest or peace. The Tea Healing Circle was created by Comfort Dondo to provide African immigrant women with a welcoming, sacred space where cultural spiced tea, familiar foods, and confidentiality allow trauma to be safely unpacked.

2. Four Pillars of Facilitation

Pillar 1: Absolute Confidentiality - what is shared in the circle never leaves the circle. Pillar 2: No Forced Disclosure - every participant owns her timeline. Pillar 3: Cultural Kinship - honoring traditional healing ways. Pillar 4: Intergenerational Solidarity.

3. Practical Session Structure

A standard 90-minute circle begins with tea service and grounding breathing 20 min, opening prompts on resilience 30 min, open sisterhood reflection 30 min, and collective affirmation with closing blessing 10 min.

4. Crisis Escalation Protocol

If a participant discloses immediate physical danger or suicidal ideation, the facilitator immediately connects her with a designated safeguarding advocate or the Day One Crisis Line.